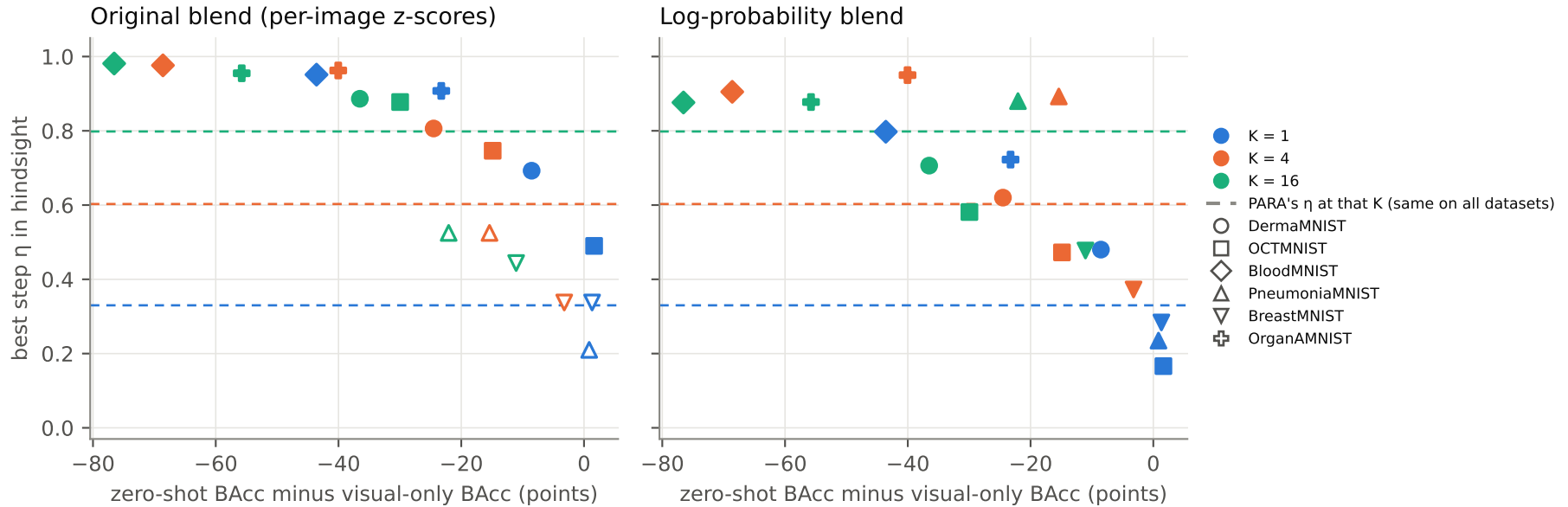
The best step tracks how good the anchor is relative to the trained branch; PARA's step (dashed) does not



Left of 0: the trained branch is better than the anchor. Hollow (left panel): 2-class datasets, where the z-score blend is a switch at η = 0.5, so the best η is not unique.